

Audit Preparation Companion

Example LLC

Calibration and test & measurement lab serving NIST-traceable measurement needs for manufacturers in Greenville, South Carolina and on-site across the region.

Issued	21 May 2026
Locale	en-US
Prepared for	Dana Whitfield
Companion to	Quality Management System Manual – Example LLC v1.0

This companion is tailored for Example LLC's upcoming ISO 9001:2015 audit and should be used alongside the current Quality Management System Manual. Each section below matches your company's documented processes, people, and KPIs, giving specific auditor questions, evidence types, timing rules, and a suggested roadmap to guide your final preparations. This approach is designed to help ensure auditors find clear, concrete answers anchored in Example LLC's real-world operation.

ISO 9001 · CHAPTER 4

Context, Processes & Risks

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ How do you ensure your calibration process—covering both in-lab and on-site jobs—meets the stated customer requirements for NIST-traceability and documentation, especially for ISO-certified automotive and aerospace customers?
- ☐ Can you walk me through how you identify and evaluate external risks such as supplier unreliability or regulatory changes, and how decisions are made as a result?
- ☐ Your manual notes risks including certificate errors, overdue reference standards, and inconsistent technician practices. Show how these were identified and what actions have been taken in response.
- ☐ What process do you follow to review your QMS scope and process map? Who is involved, and when are changes made?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Written quality policy as issued, signed and dated by Dana Whitfield.
- ☐ Risk assessment and context documentation specific to Example LLC (e.g., records of identified risks such as overdue standards or certificate errors).
- ☐ Process overview or map covering lab and on-site calibrations, signed or author-approved, showing Theresa Nguyen's, Marcus Bell's, Kevin Park's, and technician roles.
- ☐ Document showing the list of interested parties and their requirements (e.g., major clients in automotive/aerospace, external calibration suppliers, regulators such as NIST, OSHA).

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Risk/context review: At least annually and whenever significant changes arise (e.g., supplier change, regulatory update, major complaint), and records must be dated accordingly.
- ☐ Quality policy: Must be current (signed within the last annual review cycle or since the last major change).
- ☐ Process map/scope: Should reflect current operational reality and be up to date at the time of audit.
- ☐ Record retention for risk/context: As per applicable US federal and South Carolina state requirements.

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Ensure the current quality policy is formally released, signed, and communicated to all staff.
- ☐ Document risks relevant to Example LLC (certificate errors, supplier delays, overdue standards) in a dated record; review with Dana Whitfield and Marcus Bell.
- ☐ Update the process map or flow diagram, assigning responsibilities to Theresa Nguyen, Marcus Bell, Kevin Park, and technicians as described in the manual.
- ☐ Create or update a list of interested parties (customers, suppliers, regulators), with requirements and expectations explicitly stated.

ISO 9001 · CHAPTER 5

Leadership, Roles & Objectives

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Who is responsible for day-to-day quality in the lab, and how is this role communicated to staff? Show examples involving Marcus Bell's oversight.
- ☐ Explain how Example LLC's quality objectives—such as your target of 2 or fewer certificate corrections per year and 95% or better on-time delivery—are monitored, reviewed, and communicated to the team.
- ☐ How are changes to documented procedures or resource assignments (staffing/equipment) reviewed and approved—for example, when Marcus or Dana makes updates to the lab's processes?
- ☐ How is management review scheduled, who attends, and how do you ensure outputs (actions/decisions) are acted on and communicated to the rest of the team?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Organization chart or documented assignment of key roles: Dana Whitfield (owner), Marcus Bell (lab manager), Theresa Nguyen (front office), Kevin Park (standards), technicians and trainee.
- ☐ Table or records showing quality objectives: certificate correction rate, on-time delivery rate, overdue standard count. For each, include current status and tracking method.
- ☐ Sample communications or meeting minutes where quality objectives and progress are discussed (e.g., extracts from monthly team or management review meetings).
- ☐ Record of management review meetings: agenda, attendees (Dana, Marcus, Theresa, Kevin, selected technicians), decisions/actions with assigned owners, evidence of follow-up and staff communication.

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Quality objectives: Review and update at least quarterly in management or team meetings; formal evaluation at management review (at least annually).
- ☐ Management review: Evidence must be from at least one completed review within the last twelve months and should include minutes, actions, and follow-up documentation.
- ☐ Records of delegation, role assignments, and communications: Must be current and accessible at time of audit.
- ☐ Retention: As per US/South Carolina requirements, unless specified otherwise by client, regulator, or relevant program (e.g., customer-imposed retention periods).

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Identify and review all role assignments, updating the org chart and confirming responsibility for core tasks with Marcus Bell, Dana Whitfield, and supporting staff.
- ☐ Gather and document evidence of meetings (minutes, sign-in lists, action logs) where objectives, performance, and resource needs are discussed.
- ☐ Summarize current status and trends for each quality objective (correction rate, on-time delivery, overdue standards) and prepare display tables for easy reference during the audit.
- ☐ Ensure recent management review outputs and assigned follow-ups are completed and accessible for auditor review.

Process Control, Documentation & Audit

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Show how Example LLC ensures only current procedures and forms are used at technician benches and work areas. How are outdated versions removed and archived?
- ☐ Provide an example of a complete calibration record for a recent job—from customer request, job assignment by Marcus Bell, technician measurement, to package/shipment and certificate issuance by Theresa Nguyen.
- ☐ How does Kevin Park ensure that all NIST-traceable reference standards remain current and within tolerance? What happens when one is found out of tolerance?
- ☐ Describe the process for conducting an internal audit: who plans and executes the audit, what records are reviewed, and how are findings addressed?
- ☐ Can you show a record of your last management review, including the discussion of audit findings, customer complaints, and actions taken?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Master document list for quality procedures, work instructions, and controlled forms, including version/date and revision history, with signatures/approvals.
- ☐ Sample calibration record set: order log (Theresa Nguyen), job assignment (Marcus Bell), raw measurements/bench notes (technician), final certificate, and shipping/return record.
- ☐ Reference standard status tracking log: due dates, evidencing monitoring by Kevin Park, with records of certificates from external calibration providers and actions taken for any out-of-tolerance findings.
- ☐ Internal audit plan (annual), scope/checklists, audit reports with objective evidence, findings, assigned corrective actions, and follow-up tracking (by Dana Whitfield).
- ☐ Management review meeting minutes with full agenda (objectives, audit results, complaints, improvements), action items, and evidence of staff communication.

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Document control: Procedure and records must be currently valid; superseded/archived documents must be retrievable with clear version/date traces.
- ☐ Calibration records: Show at least several sets covering a period of live QMS operation (typically at least three months before Stage 2 audit).
- ☐ Reference standard monitoring: Ongoing, with evidence for each standard showing no overdue status since Q1 2026 as per current objective.
- ☐ Internal audits: At least annually, with all significant process areas (lab and on-site calibration, document control, supplier handling) audited over the cycle.
- ☐ Management review: Minimum frequency is annually; records must be from within the last year for Stage 2 readiness.
- ☐ Retention: All records as per applicable federal and state requirements for calibration and quality records (do not destroy until retention schedule reviewed for audit).

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Complete the master list of documents/forms in use, confirming version control steps and archiving procedures are followed and up to date.
- ☐ Compile at least three sample full calibration record sets (job log, bench notes, certificate, shipment) ready for review, checking all required fields are present and legible.
- ☐ Ensure the reference standard monitoring log is current, with no overdue items, and documented evidence of periodic reviews by Kevin Park.
- ☐ Schedule or conduct an internal audit of at least one full process cycle (lab and on-site jobs), and prepare a completed audit report with findings and corrective action assignments for auditor review.
- ☐ Gather management review records, including actions/decisions and evidence of communication to the technician team.

ISO 9001 · CHAPTER 9–10

Performance, Improvement & Corrective Action

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Your target is 2 or fewer certificate corrections per year. How are certificate errors detected, tracked, and analyzed? Who is responsible for corrective actions?
- ☐ Show a recent example where a customer reported a problem (e.g., wrong unit or missing data)—how was the complaint handled from log by Theresa through root cause review by Marcus, and what corrective action was taken?
- ☐ Explain the process for identifying patterns or repeated issues that require systemic change (updated procedure or retraining), as opposed to one-off errors. How are effectiveness checks performed?

- ☐ What input do technicians and staff have in identifying improvement opportunities or procedural changes? Can you show an example of a lesson learned being built into operations?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Corrective action and issue log or software extract: complaint record (Theresa Nguyen), bench record review, root cause analysis (Marcus Bell), assigned action, status and closure notes.
- ☐ Records showing periodic (at least quarterly) review of nonconformities and trends (e.g., summary tables or charts for certificate corrections and turnaround time KPIs).
- ☐ Samples of training records and/or revised procedure documentation following a recurring error or update driven by staff suggestion.
- ☐ Evidence that management and staff review effectiveness of corrective actions (e.g., follow-up meeting notes, validation tests, reduction in repeated errors).

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Corrective action logs: Ongoing; must include both open and closed records, showing live tracking as of audit date.
- ☐ KPI and trend reviews: At least quarterly, with the last review no older than three months before the audit.
- ☐ Training and procedural update records: Must be current as of the last identified process improvement; for recurring issues, show evidence spanning at least two cycles (problem and verification of effectiveness).
- ☐ Retention of improvement/CA records: As per US requirements for quality and calibration actions; retain long enough to evidence trend analysis and auditor spot-checks (typically several years for systemic issues).

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Verify the corrective action/issue log is up to date, with clear record of certificate errors, root cause analyses, assigned actions, follow-up and closure for at least one resolved case in the last three months.
- ☐ Prepare evidence (meeting notes, charts) of regular review of certificate correction rates, on-time delivery rates, and overdue standard counts—show actions for any that exceed targets.
- ☐ Ensure that for at least one process improvement, you have both the initial staff suggestion or incident, evidence of follow-up action, and subsequent check for effectiveness.
- ☐ Remind Marcus Bell, Dana Whitfield, and Theresa Nguyen to be ready to explain recent complaints, actions, and their role in implementing and verifying improvements in front of the auditor.